

And since it is Google TV, you get built-in Google Assistant for voice commands, and for casting, there is both Chromecast and AirPlay support. So, you have pretty much everything one expects in this segment.

REMOTE AND CONNECTIVITY

The Vu Vibe DV stands out because of the integrated soundbar beneath the display. There is a massive Vu insignia on this soundbar. So, there is no confusion about the brand name. It is a purposeful design choice. The rest of it is routine stuff: inverted-V stands, slim bezels on three sides, a tad thicker chin, to which the soundbar is connected.

On the left side (behind the TV), you get the IO lineup, including three HDMI ports, one with eARC support, alongside two USB ports, Ethernet, optical audio out, AV input, and a headphone jack. In case you want to connect a different audio device or a soundbar, the HDMI eARC support would allow lossless audio passthrough through it.

Wireless connectivity options include dual-band Wi-Fi, Bluetooth 5.3, and Apple HomeKit.

The remote connects via Bluetooth, and it also has a thicker bottom portion. It is very handy and has the requisite buttons for navigation, input modes, volume and channel change, and OTT hotkeys. The OTT hotkeys are limited to just Netflix and YouTube. Rest, you get hotkeys for Picture, Sound, Wi-Fi, and



even two picture modes, viz., Cinema and Sports. These don't take you to any settings page; they straight-up toggle or cycle through the modes in question. Perhaps, the idea is that these are the most commonly used settings on a TV by Vu's target audience. It makes sense.

VERDICT

The Vu Vibe DV has a head-turning design and interesting features like a 55-inch 4K HDR QLED panel, an 88W integrated soundbar, Google TV OS, and a decent connectivity setup. The panel produces appealing visuals, and most users will have a good 4K viewing experience on this TV. The speaker setup delivers fairly loud and engaging sound. The software experience is neat and easy to use, with hiccups that are par for the course in this price bracket.

However, some things could have been better, like the audio tuning, as well as the colour and contrast calibration. We would have also appreciated more software updates and additional HDMI 2.1 ports.

For what's on offer, especially at around Rs 35,000, the Vu Vibe DV should be serviceable for regular users. You are getting a balanced 55-inch QLED TV. But the market has other options like the Lumio Vision 7 (review) at this price. However, that TV has its own downsides, such as weaker shadow detail. So ultimately, the choice depends on what matters more to you.

The Vu Vibe DV QLED TV is a pretty decent option for its asking price.

—G. S. Vasan

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: A+ Grade QLED Panel | Resolution: 4K Ultra HD | Brightness: 400 nits | Picture Engine: 1.5GHz VuOn™ AI Processor with AI Smart Scene & Upscale | Audio output: 88 W | Speakers: Integrated 88W soundbar with Dolby Atmos support | OS: Google TV OS | Processor: 1.5GHz VuOn™ AI Processor with Turbo Mode | RAM and storage: 2 GB + 16 GB | Connectivity: Dual Band Wi-Fi and 2-way Bluetooth 5.3 | Ports: 3x HDMI, 2x USB, 1x Ethernet, 1x Optical Digital Audio Out, 1x AV Input, 1x Audio Jack

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